

The Permission to Grieve

Lament as a Biblical Practice, Not a Spiritual Failure

"Jesus wept." — John 11:35

KEY CONCEPTS

1 Jesus wept — and so can you

'Jesus wept' is the shortest verse in the Bible and possibly the most radical. God incarnate, standing at the tomb of his friend, wept. Not because he lacked faith. Not because he doubted. But because grief is the honest response to real loss. If Jesus wept, so can you.

2 The Psalms are the original trauma processing

Nearly a third of the Psalms are lament — raw, unfiltered grief and anger directed at God. 'How long, Lord?' 'Where are you?' 'Why have you forgotten me?' God didn't edit these out of Scripture. He preserved them. Because honest lament is a form of relationship, not faithlessness.

3 What you're actually grieving

You're not just grieving the relationship. You're grieving the illusion of who they were, the years you gave, the version of yourself you lost, and the future you imagined. Each of these is a real loss. Each deserves space. Skipping the grief doesn't get you past it — it buries it in your body.

THIS WEEK'S PRACTICE

Write a one-paragraph lament — raw and honest, directed at God. Don't dress it up. Start with: 'God, I am angry about...' or 'God, I don't understand why...' Let it be real. He can handle it.

YOUR REFLECTION

'My grief is not faithlessness. It is the honest response to real loss. God is big enough for my lament.'

YOUR NOTES & JOURNAL SPACE

WANT TO GO DEEPER?

Inside the full Reclaim Your Self community, we spend an entire week on grief with a Grief Layers Mapping tool — helping you identify and name each distinct loss so nothing gets skipped. Join us at \$27/month.

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